

CLAUDE.md

CLAUDE.md

Field	Value
Revision	1
Created	2026-05-15
Last modified	2026-05-19
Status	active
Status summary	—
Issues	none
Issues summary	—
Fixed	none
Fixed summary	—
Continuation	—

Table of contents

- [INHERITED FROM Helix Constitution \(parent-discovery\)](#)
- [Project status](#)
- [Mission \(from the spec\)](#)
- [Intended stack](#)
- [Multi-host mirror convention](#)
- [Inheritance gate \(run before any commit touching root docs\)](#)
- [Spec-change rule \(load-bearing — docs/specs/mvp/specification.md §"Specification documents"\)](#)
- [Project conventions from the spec \(apply when scaffolding\)](#)
- [constitutable/ directory \(parent-project extension hook\)](#)
- [Documentation artefacts \(PDF/HTML siblings\)](#)
- [Notes for future scaffolding](#)

This file provides guidance to Claude Code (claude.ai/code) when working with code in this repository.

INHERITED FROM Helix Constitution (parent-discovery)

Herald is consumed as a submodule of a parent project that already carries the Helix Constitution submodule at <parent>/constitution/. Herald therefore does **NOT** keep its own copy. Locate the constitution from any nested depth by walking up parents until you find <ancestor>/constitution/Constitution.md, or by running the canonical helper:

```
CONST_DIR="$(bash "$(find . -type d -name constitution -print -quit 2>/dev/null)/find_constitution.sh)"  
# or, more robustly, from any starting directory:  
CONST_DIR="$(bash <ancestor>/constitution/find_constitution.sh)"
```

For standalone development of Herald (no parent project), clone the constitution alongside Herald:

```
git clone git@github.com:HelixDevelopment/HelixConstitution.git \  
$(dirname "$PWD")/constitution
```

Once located, all rules in <discovered>/CLAUDE.md and the <discovered>/Constitution.md it references apply unconditionally. Herald-specific rules below extend them — they **MUST NOT** weaken any inherited rule. When this file disagrees with the discovered constitution, the constitution wins.

Canonical: <https://github.com/HelixDevelopment/HelixConstitution>

Read order on a cold start:

1. <discovered-constitution>/CLAUDE.md + Constitution.md — universal Helix rules. Inherited unconditionally.
2. <discovered-constitution>/AGENTS.md — agent guardrails (anti-bluff, no-guessing, paired mutations).
3. README.md — Herald overview + how-to.
4. This file (Herald-specific notes below).
5. docs/guides/HERALD_CONSTITUTION.md — Herald's project-specific constitutional extensions.
6. docs/guides/CONSTITUTION_INHERITANCE.md — operator/agent guide for the discovery contract + the inheritance gate.
7. docs/specs/mvp/specification.md — mission spec (mostly TBD).

Project status

Herald is **pre-implementation**. As of this writing the repo contains:

- README.md — mission, deployment model, inheritance contract, quickstart.
- docs/specs/mvp/specification.md — MVP spec stub (substantive sections TBD).
- docs/guides/HERALD_CONSTITUTION.md — Herald's project constitution (extends Helix).
- docs/guides/CONSTITUTION_INHERITANCE.md — operator/agent guide for parent-discovery + gate semantics.

- `upstreams/` — Herald's mirror declarations (see below).
- `tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh + _meta.sh` — paired inheritance gate (§1.1).
- `.gitignore` tuned for Go + `.DS_Store`.

Herald does **not** ship a `constitution/` submodule of its own; the parent project provides it. See `docs/guides/CONSTITUTION_INHERITANCE.md`.

There is no `go.mod`, no source code, and no build/test/lint tooling yet. When the user asks you to "add a feature" or "fix" something, first confirm whether they want you to **scaffold the project** (init the module, lay out packages) or **fill in the spec** — the answer determines whether you're writing Go or Markdown.

Do not invent build/test commands or pretend infrastructure exists. If a command is needed but the supporting file (`go.mod`, `Makefile`, CI config) isn't present, say so and ask before scaffolding it.

Mission (from the spec)

Ingesting system events and reliably fanning them out to multiple notification channels so every alert reaches the right destination without confusion.

The spec mentions "Integration into the Constitution" as a planned section — Herald is intended to plug into a larger governance/policy system that lives outside this repo. Treat that as a real constraint when designing interfaces, even though the details are TBD.

Intended stack

Go, inferred from `.gitignore` (`*.test`, `go.work`, `go.work.sum`, `coverage.*`, `profile.cov`). When you scaffold, default to standard `cmd/ + internal/` layout unless the user asks otherwise, and use `go test ./... / go build ./... / go vet ./...` — there is no project-specific tooling to override these yet.

Multi-host mirror convention

`upstreams/` contains one script per mirror host:

- `GitHub.sh` — primary: `git@github.com:vasic-digital/Herald.git`
- `GitLab.sh` — `git@gitlab.com:vasic-digital/herald.git`
- `GitFlic.sh` — `git@gitflic.ru:vasic-digital/herald.git`
- `GitVerse.sh` — `git@gitverse.ru:vasic-digital/Herald.git`

Each script exports a single `UPSTREAMABLE_REPOSITORY` variable and is meant to be **sourced** (`. upstreams/GitHub.sh`), not executed for its output. The naming is intentional — capitalization matches the host's brand (GitFlic, GitVerse). Don't normalize these to lowercase or collapse them into one file; the per-host split is the interface other tooling (likely external mirror-push scripts) keys on.

When adding a new mirror, copy an existing script and change only the URL — keep the `#!/bin/bash` shebang, blank line, and export form identical so any consumer that greps these files keeps working.

Inheritance gate (run before any commit touching root docs)

```
bash tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh          # 6 invariants
              (I1–I6), 9 checks
bash tests/test_constitution_inheritance_meta.sh     # paired §1.1
              mutation proof
```

The gate inline-walks parents for `<ancestor>/constitution/Constitution.md`. I5 is split into I5a–d (one check per root doc that must declare parent-discovery: `CLAUDE.md`, `AGENTS.md`, `docs/guides/HERALD_CONSTITUTION.md`, `README.md`). I6 forbids re-introducing `<repo-root>/constitution/` or `.gitmodules` — the §104 invariant.

If either script fails, fix at root cause per Universal §11.4.4. Never silently accept the FAIL.

Spec-change rule (load-bearing — docs/specs/mvp/specification.md §"Specification documents")

Any modification to a file under `docs/specs/` (any depth) triggers **mandatory comprehensive planning and implementation** of the implied changes — you may not edit the spec in isolation. This rule does **not** apply to creating or renaming files; for those, ask the operator what to do with the new path. Treat every spec edit as a project-wide ripple, not a doc tweak.

Project conventions from the spec (apply when scaffolding)

These are declared in `docs/specs/mvp/specification.md` and are easy to miss because no code enforces them yet:

- **Workable-item prefix:** HRD– (e.g. HRD–001). Use it for issues, status entries, fix logs.
- **Flavor binaries:** each Herald flavor ships as its own CLI binary, named `<prefix>herald` — `pherald` (Project Herald), `sherald` (System Herald), etc. Designed for CI / pipeline / cron / AI-agent invocation.
- **Layered shared code:** `commons` → `commons_messaging` (level 1) → ... → flavor. Put new shared code in the **lowest layer that still makes sense**; flavors inherit upward. `commons_messaging` owns the Telegram / Max / Slack / Email / Markdown-export integrations.
- **Messenger integration priority:** Telegram → Max → Slack (then Email, then Markdown/PDF/HTML export). Microsoft Teams, Lark, Discord, WhatsApp, Viber are explicitly later iterations — don't pre-implement.

- **Conversation diary:** every message in/out is appended to docs/herald/diary/main.md and re-exported to main.pdf + main.html in sync. Don't break this invariant when designing channel I/O.
- **Container stack:** Postgres (main DB) + Redis (in-memory) bundled via the containers submodule (<https://github.com/vasic-digital/containers>). All container names start with herald; all host ports start with 70XXX (70001, 70002, ...) to avoid collisions.
- **Credentials:** .env (git-ignored) with a committed .env.example. Resolution order: exported shell vars from .bashrc/.zshrc load first, then .env overrides them on key collision.
- **Vendored SDKs:** any official/unofficial messenger SDK or API client we depend on goes in as a **git submodule**, e.g. commons_messaging/sdk/telegram or commons_messaging/api/telegram — not go get'd into go.mod.

constitutable/ directory (parent-project extension hook)

The empty constitutable/ directory at the repo root is intentional. Per the spec, a parent project may drop additional Constitution.md / CLAUDE.md / AGENTS.md (in constitutable/, constitutable/<flavor>/, constitutable/<flavor>/<variant>/, etc.) to layer extensions or overrides on top of the discovered constitution/ submodule. Apply-order: constitution/ submodule → constitutable/ extensions → Herald's own docs. Do not delete the directory because it's empty.

Documentation artefacts (PDF/HTML siblings)

docs/guides/HERALD_CONSTITUTION.md and docs/guides/CONSTITUTION_INHERITANCE.md each ship with a committed .pdf sibling. When you edit one of these Markdown files, the PDF goes stale — flag it; do not regenerate silently unless the operator asks.

Notes for future scaffolding

- The repo is in main branch and committed under "Milos Vasic" — no other contributors yet.
- .claude/ exists but is empty; project-local Claude config can go there.
- LICENSE is present (do not overwrite without asking).
- .DS_Store is now git-ignored; do not re-add the previously-stray files.